

# DataMover

## User guide

Verified offload for video production: source → verification → independent copies

For DataMover 2.19.0 · macOS and Windows

gordas.dev/datamover

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# 1 What DataMover does

DataMover copies footage from a card or folder to several independent drives at the same time. The source is read **once**, and every copy is compared with the source by checksum before it gets its final name.

- **Source** — the camera card or a folder.
- **Verification** — each copy's checksum must match the source's.
- **Independent copies** — two or more drives, each with its own result and reports.

> ! Do not format the card until every destination shows **Verified**. DataMover lowers the risk of copying; it does not remove it.

# 2 Installing on macOS

Requirements: macOS 14 or later on an Apple Silicon Mac. The package is Developer ID signed and notarized by Apple, so Gatekeeper opens it without extra steps.

1. Download **DataMover.dmg** from gordas.dev/datamover.
2. Open the DMG. The window contains the **DataMover-x.y.z.pkg** package and this guide.
3. Double-click the package and follow the steps. Accept the license agreement.
4. When asked, enter your Mac's administrator password (the characters are not shown — this is normal), then press Enter.
5. Launch DataMover from the **Applications** folder.

# 3 Installing on Windows

Requirements: Windows 11, 64-bit (x64). On ARM64 computers the app runs through the system's x64 emulation.

1. Download **DataMover-WPF-Windows.zip** and extract it.
2. Run **DataMoverSetup.exe** and accept the license agreement.
3. The app is installed in Program Files with a Start menu shortcut. The Desktop shortcut is optional; you tick it in the wizard.

> ! The Windows installer has a **self-signed** signature, not a commercial certificate. Windows SmartScreen may show “Windows protected your PC” or “Unknown publisher”. If you downloaded the file from gordas.dev, click **More info** → **Run anyway**.

Uninstall from **Settings → Apps**. The uninstaller asks whether to keep the licence and the computer key for a reinstall; if you choose to delete them, it also removes DataMover's settings and diagnostic logs (data of other GDC apps is left untouched), and after reinstalling you request a new licence for the computer.

## 4 Updates

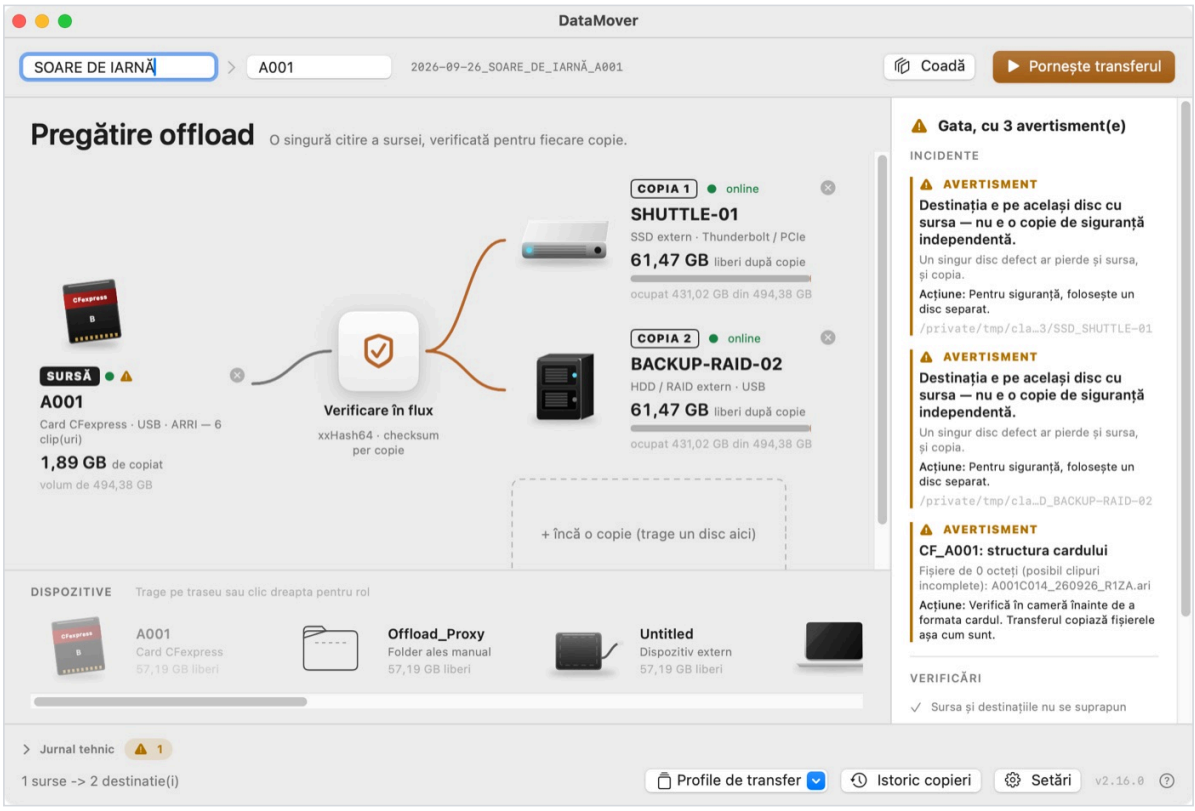
At launch, DataMover checks for a new version and shows you the version number and what's new. You can also check manually from the app.

- **macOS** — **Download & Install** downloads the package, checks its version and signature, asks for your administrator password and restarts the app. **Later** postpones that version.
- **Windows** — in the “Actualizare disponibilă” (update available) window, **Yes** downloads the installer, checks its signature and integrity, then opens the setup wizard; the app closes and starts again after installation. **No** postpones the update.
- An update is never installed in the background without your consent.
- A package whose signature or integrity cannot be confirmed is rejected, and the installed version stays unchanged. An update never starts during a transfer.

## 5 Preparing an offload

Fill in **Project** and **Card** in the top bar. They form the name of the folder created on each destination (for example 2026-09-26_PROJECT_A001).

- **Source** — drag the card or folder onto the Source area, use the add button, or pick it from the device list.
- **Destinations** — add at least one copy; for safety, use two different drives. On macOS, drag a drive onto “+ another copy” or choose its role from the device menu; on Windows, click **Copy** under the device.
- **Verification** — xxHash64 by default (fast). You can choose MD5, SHA-1, SHA-256, SHA-512 or “size only” in Settings.




macOS, preparation: the source, both copies and the warnings before start (interface in Romanian).

# 6 Checks before you start

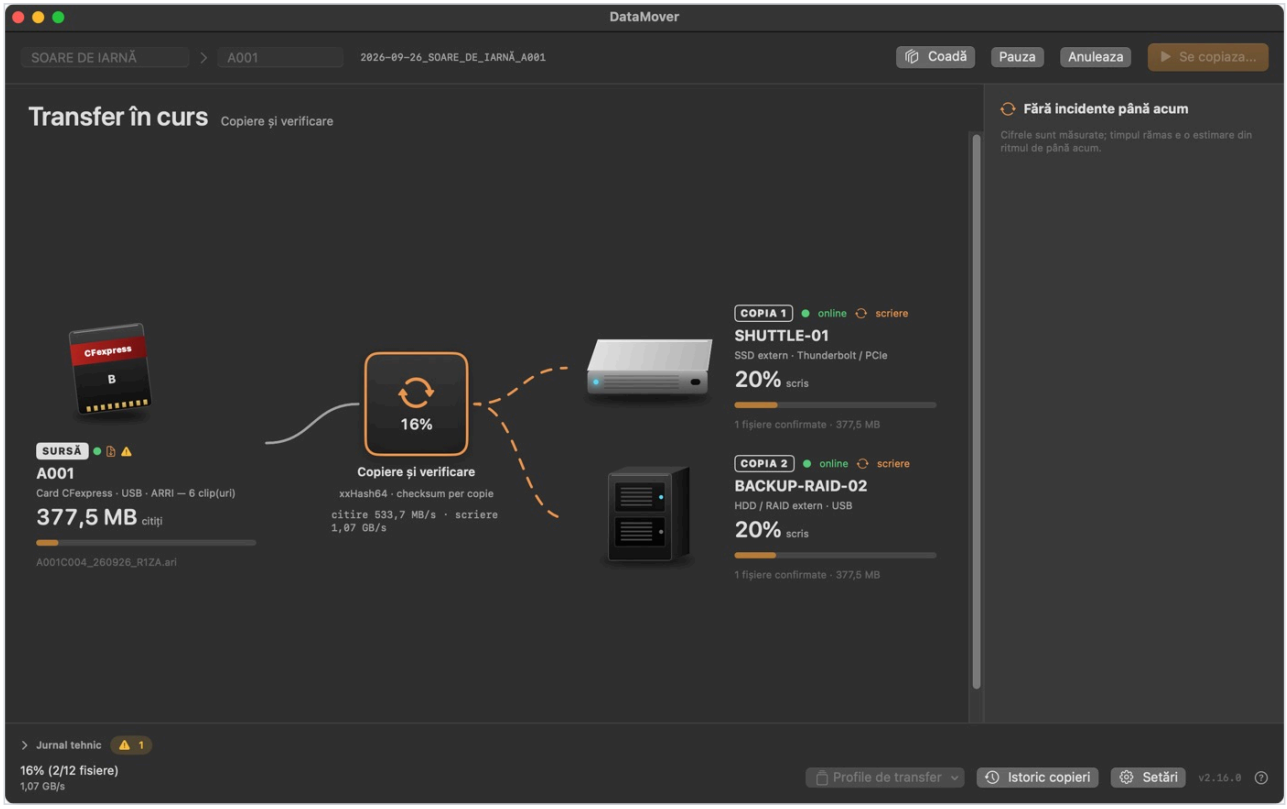
Before you start, the app checks the route. **Blocking** problems disable the start button; **warnings** don't block, but are worth reading before you format the card.

| Situation | Type |
|---|---|
| Destination inside the source (or the other way round) | Blocking |
| The same destination picked twice, nested destinations | Blocking |
| Missing path or no write permission, name collisions | Blocking |
| A copy would sit on the same drive as the source | Warning |
| Not enough space at a destination | Warning, with confirmation |
| Unusual card structure (e.g. 0-byte files) | Warning |

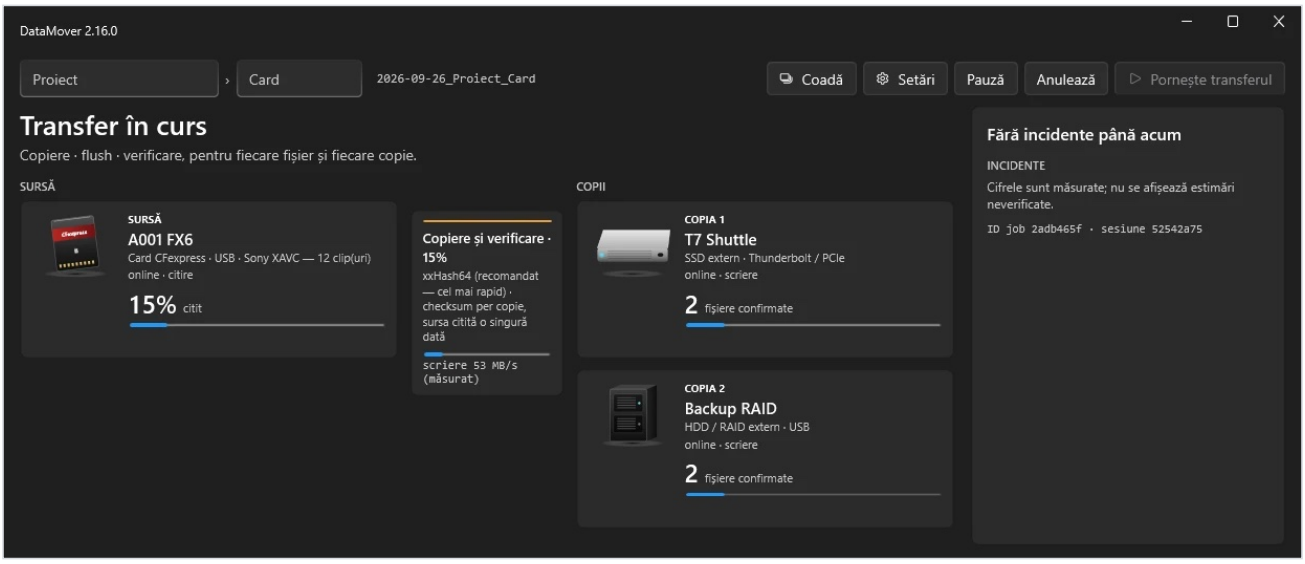
# 7 Transfer and verification

Click **Start transfer**. The source is read once and written to every copy in parallel. Each file is written first with the temporary **.dmpart** extension and gets its final name only after the flush to disk and after the copy's checksum matches the source.

- Progress is shown for each destination; the figures are measured, not estimated.
- You can **Pause** or **Cancel** the transfer.
- If a drive disconnects, the problem shows up only for its destination; the other copies carry on.
- A file that changes on the card during the copy is marked unconfirmed.




macOS, transfer in progress: measured progress for each copy.

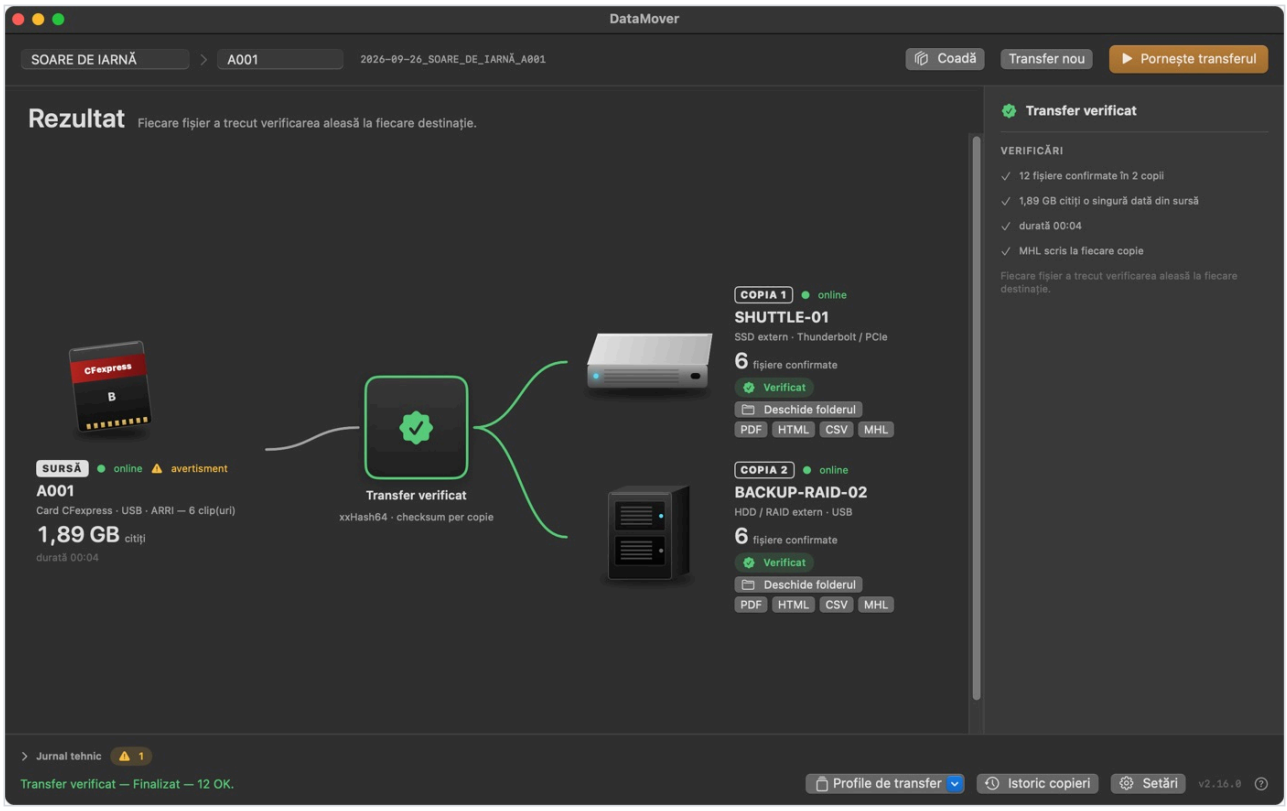


Windows, transfer in progress: the same logic in a native Windows interface.

## 8 The result

At the end you get one unambiguous verdict and a result for each destination.

| Verdict | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Verified | Every file passed the selected verification at every destination. |
| Verified, with warnings | Everything is confirmed, but some files only succeeded on retry. Check the cable, card and drives. |
| Partial failure | At least one destination has unconfirmed files. Do not format the card. |
| Failure | No destination has a complete confirmed copy. |
| Cancelled | The transfer was stopped; confirmed files are kept. |



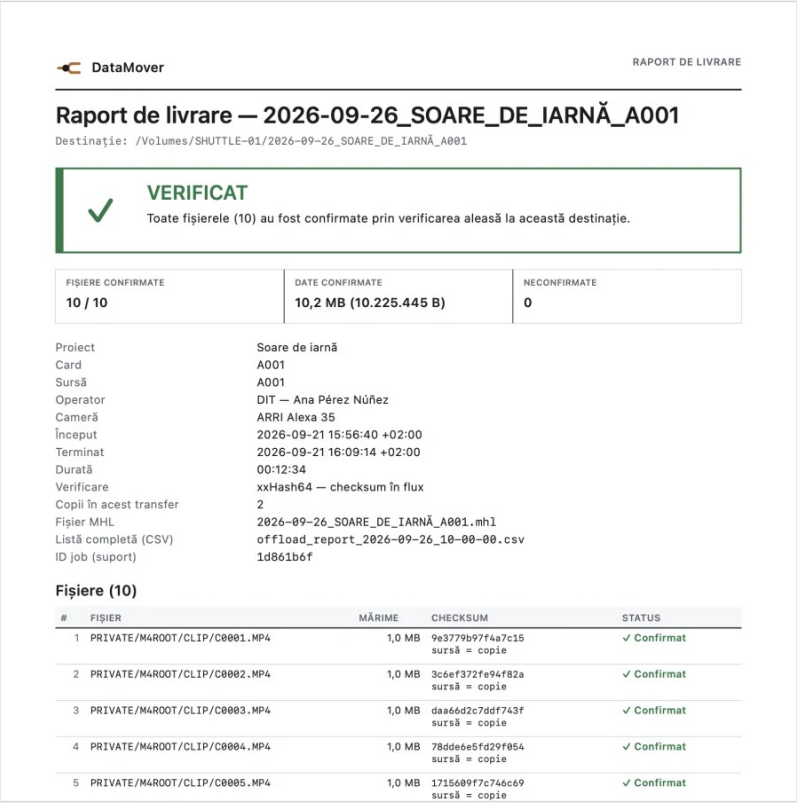
macOS, result: each copy confirmed on its own, with its reports.

> ¡ Automatic card ejection (optional, in Settings) happens only when every destination has a confirmed copy.

## 9 Delivery reports

In the folder created on each destination, DataMover writes:

- **PDF and HTML** — the delivery report: the destination's verdict, a summary (files, data confirmed, duration, verification), project, card, operator and the file list with checksum and status. The HTML opens in any browser and prints on A4.
- **CSV** — the full list, one row per file (columns: file, size, source check, destination check, status, error). It is UTF-8 with a byte-order mark so accented characters read correctly.
- **MHL** — the hash list for the post-production chain of custody. It is generated only with xxHash64, MD5 or SHA-1, the algorithms the MHL standard accepts.
- **offload_checkpoint.json** — used when resuming.



DataMover RAPORT DE LIVRARE

Raport de livrare — 2026-09-26_SOARE_DE_IARNĂ_A001

Destinație: /Volumes/SHUTTLE-01/2026-09-26_SOARE_DE_IARNĂ_A001

VERIFICAT

Toate fișierele (10) au fost confirmate prin verificarea aleasă la această destinație.

| FIȘIERE CONFIRMATE | DATE CONFIRMATE | NECONFIRMATE |
|---|---|---|
| 10 / 10 | 10,2 MB (10.225.445 B) | 0 |

| | |
|---|---|
| Proiect | Soare de iarnă |
| Card | A001 |
| Sursă | A001 |
| Operator | DIT — Ana Pérez Núñez |
| Cameră | ARRI Alexa 35 |
| Început | 2026-09-21 15:56:40 +02:00 |
| Terminat | 2026-09-21 16:09:14 +02:00 |
| Durată | 00:12:34 |
| Verificare | xxHash64 — checksum în flux |
| Copii în acest transfer | 2 |
| Fișier MHL | 2026-09-26_SOARE_DE_IARNĂ_A001.mhl |
| Listă completă (CSV) | offload_report_2026-09-26_10-00-00.csv |
| ID job (suport) | 1d861b6f |

Fișiere (10)

| # | FIȘIER | MĂRIME | CHECKSUM | STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | PRIVATE/M4ROOT/CLIP/C0001.MP4 | 1,0 MB | 9e3779b97f4a7c15 sursă = copie | ✓ Confirmat |
| 2 | PRIVATE/M4ROOT/CLIP/C0002.MP4 | 1,0 MB | 3c6ef372fe94f82a sursă = copie | ✓ Confirmat |
| 3 | PRIVATE/M4ROOT/CLIP/C0003.MP4 | 1,0 MB | daa66d2c7ddf743f sursă = copie | ✓ Confirmat |
| 4 | PRIVATE/M4ROOT/CLIP/C0004.MP4 | 1,0 MB | 78dde6e5fd29f054 sursă = copie | ✓ Confirmat |
| 5 | PRIVATE/M4ROOT/CLIP/C0005.MP4 | 1,0 MB | 1715609f7c746c69 sursă = copie | ✓ Confirmat |

First page of the PDF report (test data, in Romanian).

> **i** For very large transfers, the PDF and HTML show every problem plus a sample; the full list is in the CSV.

## 10 Resuming a transfer

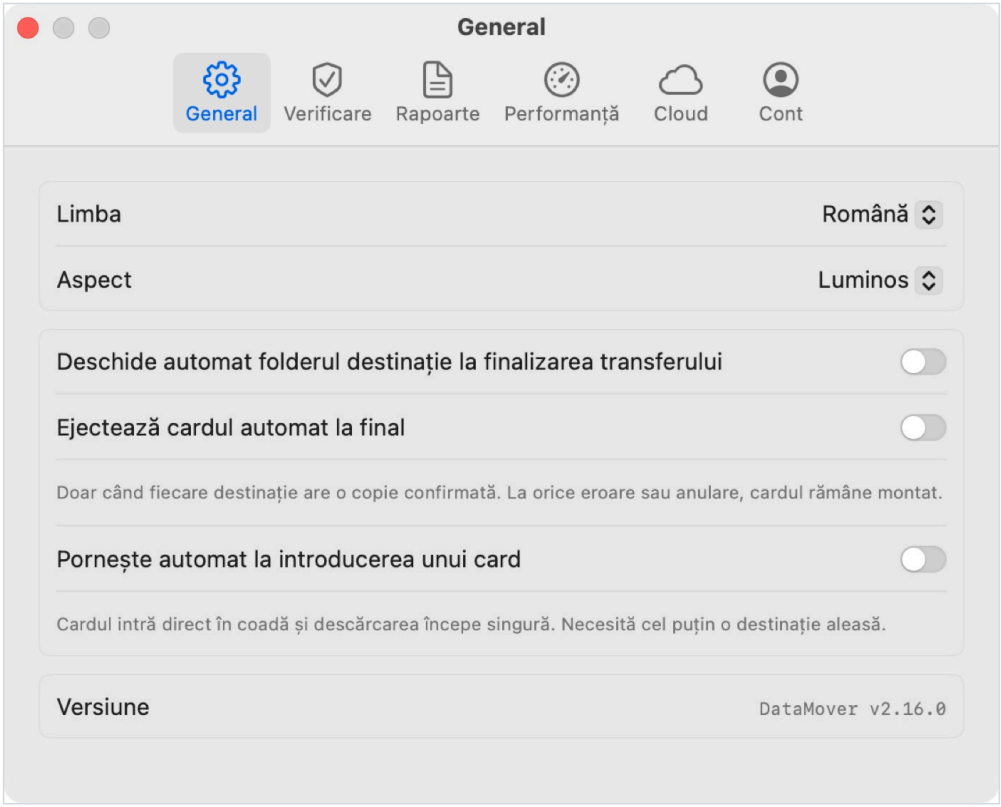
If a transfer was interrupted, start it again with the same source and destinations. With **Resume automatically from an existing checkpoint** (on by default), DataMover re-reads the source and the copy of every file already confirmed: they must match the checksum saved at confirmation, otherwise the file is copied again.

- A name, size or date alone is never enough to skip a file.
- A checkpoint made with another algorithm or for another folder is ignored.
- In “size only” mode, resuming copies everything again.

> **!** Resuming has been tested after simulated interruptions. Behaviour after a real power cut or a physically removed drive has not been verified yet — after such an incident, check the final result.

# 11 Settings and language

**macOS** — DataMover menu → Settings, with the General, Verification, Reports, Performance, Cloud, Account and Diagnostics tabs. In General you choose the language (Romanian, English, Spanish) and the appearance (System, Light, Dark), plus opening the destination, ejecting the card and starting automatically when a card is inserted.




macOS, Settings → General (interface in Romanian).

**Windows** — the **Settings** button in the top bar: verification, MHL, automatic retry, performance profile, report logo and theme. The Windows interface is in Romanian.

# 12 Diagnostics

DataMover keeps a local technical log. Nothing is sent automatically. If you have a problem, export the diagnostics and send us the ZIP file.

- **macOS** — Help → Export diagnostics… (or Settings → Diagnostics).
- **Windows** — the **Diagnostic** button at the bottom → Export diagnostics.
- The export contains the logs, the version and a summary of the last transfer. Paths and file names are replaced with codes; it contains no media files, passwords or license codes.

# 13 Differences between macOS and Windows

Both apps follow the same copy rules and produce the same kinds of reports with the same information. The interfaces are native and differ:

| | macOS | Windows |
|---|---|---|
| Interface language | Romanian, English, Spanish | Romanian |
| Report language | The app's language | Windows language (ro/en/es), else Romanian |
| Signing | Developer ID, notarized by Apple | Self-signed (SmartScreen may warn) |
| Updating | Automatic install, with password | The Windows setup wizard |
| In-app guide | Help, in the app's language | Guide button, in Romanian |

# 14 Demo and licence

- **Demo** is free and permanent: every feature is available, but each new transfer can be at most **1 GB** (1,000,000,000 bytes). There is no trial period and no time limit.
- A transfer of exactly 1 GB is allowed; a larger one is stopped **before anything is copied**, with a message. You can split the transfer or request a licence.

**How to get a licence, step by step**

1. Open **Licence and activation**: on macOS from the Demo bar at the top (the **Licence and activation** button) or from **Settings**; on Windows from the Demo bar at the bottom or from **Profile → Licence and activation**.
2. Choose an offer from the signed list, enter your name and e-mail address and press **Send the request**. Only then does the request reach us, with the chosen offer and the computer's technical data (its identifier and the device public key); it contains no files, paths or projects. The address is not verified with a code.
3. Optionally, press **Open WhatsApp** or **Open e-mail** (or **Copy request**): the message carries the identifier of the same request and the chosen offer. You decide whether to send it. If the list of offers cannot be loaded, you can ask for the licence by message only (**Prepare request**).
4. We reply. If the licence is obtained by **donation**, we tell you how you can donate; once we have manually confirmed the donation we issue the licence. The request is not proof of a donation. Licences can also be granted **free of charge** (prizes, contests, events, collaborations, testing, education).

5. Press **Check approval** (or reopen the window): the approved licence is picked up and activated by itself, with no code to copy. If we send it to you by message (text starting with **GDC3-** or a **.dmlicense** file), paste it into the "I have received the licence" box or import it, then press **Activate**. **Withdraw the request** removes only the copy on this computer; the request already sent stays with us, and to cancel it or delete its data you write to us.
6. The app verifies the licence on your computer and confirms it online. If you have no internet at that moment, the licence works within the offline window set at issue, and the confirmation happens by itself at the first connection.

### What the messages in the licence window mean

- **Licence active until …** — you have full access. "Activation confirmed online" means the server confirmed it; "verified on this computer" means it is waiting for a connection.
- **Online confirmation needed** — the licence is valid but the offline window has ended. Connect to the internet; until then you stay in Demo (1 GB per transfer).
- **The licence has expired** or **is no longer active on this computer** — you return to Demo. The app stays open and **nothing is deleted**: files, settings, history and checkpoints remain.
- A transfer that is **already running** finishes. A large transfer **interrupted** after expiry cannot be resumed without a valid licence; once you activate one, you resume from where it stopped.

### More computers, changes, reinstalling

- The licence is tied to the computer it was issued for (and to the app's key on it). The number of computers is the one in your licence.
- **Remove from this computer** frees the slot (if you are online) and returns you to Demo; the licence stays saved and you can import it again.
- If you change computers or reinstall the app, send a new request from that computer: we issue the licence for the new installation.
- The licence duration (hours, days, months, one year or lifetime) comes from your offer or grant. "Lifetime" means no expiry date, not a promise of development forever.
- The full terms and the list of open-source components: **Help → Terms of use** / **Open Source Notices** (macOS) or **Profile → Terms of use** / **Open Source Notices** (Windows).

## 15 Known limits

The scenarios below have not been verified yet. Don't consider them covered until you have tested them in your setup:

- a real power cut or hard shutdown during a copy;
- a card or drive physically removed during a transfer;
- network destinations (SMB) and exFAT drives on Windows;
- a real full disk on Windows;

— keyboard-only navigation and screen readers on Windows.